

Word family: **race / races / raced / racing / racer / racecourse / racetrack**

Base word: race

Plural: races

Past tense: raced

Past participle: raced

** -ing form:** racing

Related forms: racer, racing

Useful constructions/extensions: race against someone, race to + place, race against time, racing heart, horse race, car race, human race, racecourse, racetrack

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your passage contains:

> “My heart would **race**, my mind would go blank, and I would start imagining the worst.”

Here, **race** is a **verb**.

It does **not** mean taking part in a sporting competition.

It means:

to move or happen extremely quickly — here, for the heart to beat very fast because of nervousness.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **my heart would race**

race means:

to beat very quickly, especially because of fear, anxiety, excitement, or physical exertion.

Meaning: To move or beat at a very high speed.

繁體中文: **迅速跳動；這裡指因緊張而心跳明顯加快**

中文翻譯:

> “My heart would race, my mind would go blank...”

「我會**心跳加速**，腦袋一片空白……」

So:

****heart races = 心跳得非常快 / 心跳加速****

This is a figurative extension of the basic idea of ****moving very fast****.

1. ****race = speed competition (競速比賽) — 賽跑；競賽；速度比賽****

This is the basic noun meaning.

****Meaning:**** A competition in which people, animals, vehicles, etc. try to reach a finish point before the others.

Practice 1

> “She won the 100-metre ****race****.”

「她贏得了一百米****賽跑****。」

Practice 2

> “The car ****race**** attracted thousands of spectators.”

「這場汽車****競速賽****吸引了數千名觀眾。」

****race = 參賽者比較速度，看看誰最先到達終點的比賽****

Common:

* running race

* horse race

* car race

* boat race

2. ****race = compete in a race (參加競速比賽) — 賽跑；競賽****

Now ****race**** is a verb.

Practice 3

> “They ****raced**** each other to the finish line.”

「他們互相**賽跑**到終點。」

Practice 4

> “She **races** professionally.”

「她以專業身份參加**競速比賽**。」

****race = 在速度比賽中跟其他人競爭，看誰最快****

3. ****race against + person/team (跟.....競速) — 與.....比速度****

Practice 5

> “He **raced against** the national champion.”

「他跟全國冠軍**比賽速度**。」

Practice 6

> “The children **raced against** each other across the field.”

「孩子們在草地上互相**賽跑**。」

****race against someone = 跟另一人 / 隊伍直接比較速度****

4. ****race to + place (迅速奔向) — 飛奔；急速趕往****

A major non-competition verb meaning.

****Meaning:**** To move somewhere very quickly.

Practice 7

> “She **raced to** the station when she realized she was late.”

「她發現自己遲到後，便**飛奔到車站**。」

Practice 8

> “He **raced across** the room to answer the phone.”

「他**急步 / 飛快跑過房間**去接電話。」

****race + direction/place = 非常快速地移動到某個地方****

No competition is required.

5. ****race away/off/home (急速離開 / 趕回去) — 飛快離開 ; 趕回****

Practice 9

> “He ****raced home**** after work.”

「他下班後****飛快趕回家****。」

Practice 10

> “The car ****raced away**** from the scene.”

「汽車從現場****高速駛離****。」

****race away/off/home = 以非常快的速度離開或趕往某地****

6. ****heart races (心跳加速) — 心跳非常快****

This is the exact use in your passage.

Practice 11 — Original

> “My ****heart would race****.”

「我會****心跳加速****。」

Practice 12

> “Her ****heart raced**** when she heard her name.”

「她聽到自己的名字時，****心跳突然加快****。」

Practice 13

> “My ****heart was racing**** before I went on stage.”

「我上台前**心跳得非常快**。」

****heart races = 心臟因緊張、恐懼、興奮或運動而快速跳動****

7. ****mind/thoughts race (思緒飛快運轉) — 思緒飛轉；腦中想法不停湧現****

A very common figurative extension.

Practice 14

> “My ****mind was racing**** before the presentation.”

「簡報前，我的****腦中思緒飛快轉動 / 想個不停****。」

Practice 15

> “Her ****thoughts raced**** as she tried to decide what to do.”

「她試圖決定該怎麼做時，****腦中思緒飛快掠過****。」

****mind/thoughts race = 很多想法在短時間內快速出現，使人難以平靜****

This fits your nervousness context very naturally.

8. ****pulse races (脈搏加速) — 脈搏加快****

Practice 16

> “His ****pulse raced**** after the sudden shock.”

「受到突然驚嚇後，他的****脈搏加快****。」

Practice 17

> “Her ****pulse was racing****.”

「她的****脈搏跳得很快****。」

****pulse races = 脈搏快速跳動****

This belongs to the same physiological extension as ****heart races****.

9. **race against time** (與時間競賽) — 爭分奪秒；趕時間

A very important fixed expression.

Meaning: To try to complete something before a deadline or before it becomes too late.

Practice 18

> “We were **racing against time** to finish the slides.”

「我們為了完成投影片而**爭分奪秒**。」

Practice 19

> “Doctors were **racing against time** to save him.”

「醫生正在**跟時間競賽 / 爭分奪秒**搶救他。」

race against time = 因時間非常有限而必須極快完成某件事

This is figurative; nobody is literally racing a clock.

10. **race to do something** (爭先恐後做.....) — 爭相；搶著

A competitive figurative use.

Practice 20

> “Companies are **racing to develop** better technology.”

「各家公司都在**爭相開發**更好的科技。」

Practice 21

> “Investors **raced to buy** the shares.”

「投資者**爭相買入**股份。」

race to do something = 多方快速行動，希望比其他人更早完成 / 取得某事

11. **race for + position/prize (爭奪) — 競逐；爭奪**

Practice 22

> “Several candidates are in the **race for** the top job.”

「幾名候選人正在**爭奪最高職位**。」

Practice 23

> “The team is still in the **race for** the title.”

「這支隊伍仍然有機會**爭奪冠軍**。」

race for something = 多個人 / 團體競爭，希望取得某個職位、獎項或結果

This is broader than literal running.

12. **race = competitive struggle (競爭) — 競爭；競逐**

A broader figurative noun meaning.

Practice 24

> “The two companies are locked in a technology **race**.”

「兩家公司正在進行激烈的科技**競爭**。」

Practice 25

> “The country entered the global AI **race**.”

「該國加入了全球人工智能**競賽 / 競爭**。」

race = 多方為了領先、首先達成目標或取得優勢而展開的競爭

Common:

* arms race

* space race

* technology race

13. **arms race (軍備競賽) — 軍備競賽**

A major fixed compound.

Practice 26

> “The two countries entered an **arms race**.”

「兩國進入了**軍備競賽**。」

Practice 27

> “Experts warned of a new technological **arms race**.”

「專家警告可能出現新的科技**軍備競賽式競爭**。」

arms race = 多方互相增加軍事能力 / 武器，以免被對方超越的競爭

14. **space race (太空競賽) — 太空競賽**

Practice 28

> “The **space race** accelerated scientific research.”

「**太空競賽**加速了科學研究。」

Practice 29

> “Several countries are participating in a new **space race**.”

「多個國家正在參與新的**太空競賽**。」

space race = 不同國家 / 組織競爭率先取得重要太空科技或探索成果

15. **race = election contest (選舉競爭) — 選舉競逐**

A common political/news sense.

Practice 30

> “Three candidates entered the **race**.”

「三名候選人加入了這場**選舉競逐**。」

Practice 31

> “She withdrew from the **race**.”

「她退出了這場**競選**。」

race = 多名候選人競爭取得同一職位的選舉競賽

This is common in news English.

16. **racing = the sport/activity of racing (競速運動) — 賽車 / 賽馬 / 競速運動**

A noun/adjective-like related form.

Practice 32

> “He has always been interested in motor **racing**.”

「他一直對**賽車運動**很有興趣。」

Practice 33

> “Horse **racing** is popular in many countries.”

「**賽馬**在很多國家都很受歡迎。」

racing = 以速度競賽為核心的運動 / 活動

17. **racing car/bike (賽車 / 競賽車輛) — 賽車用的 ; 競速用的**

Practice 34

> “He drives a professional **racing car**.”

「他駕駛一輛專業**賽車**。」

Practice 35

> “The bike was designed for **racing**.”

「這輛單車是為**競速比賽**而設計的。」

racing + noun = 為速度競賽而設計 / 使用的

18. **racer = person/animal/vehicle that races (參賽者 / 賽車手) — 競速選手 ; 賽車手**

Practice 36

> “She is a professional **racer**.”

「她是一名專業**賽車手 / 競速選手**。」

Practice 37

> “The young **racer** won his first championship.”

「這名年輕**賽車手**贏得首個冠軍。」

racer = 參與速度競賽的人、動物或車輛

Context decides the natural Chinese term.

19. **racecourse (賽馬場 / 賽道) — 賽馬場 ; 競賽場地**

Practice 38

> “Thousands of spectators went to the **racecourse**.”

「數千名觀眾前往**賽馬場**。」

Practice 39

> “The **racecourse** was wet after heavy rain.”

「大雨後**賽道 / 賽馬場跑道**很濕。」

racecourse = 特別為賽馬或其他競速活動設置的場地 / 路線

Especially common in British English for horse racing.

20. **racetrack** (賽道) — 賽車道；競速跑道

Practice 40

> “The cars returned to the **racetrack**.”

「賽車返回**賽道**。」

Practice 41

> “The **racetrack** has several sharp corners.”

「這條**賽道**有幾個急彎。」

racetrack = 為車輛、跑步或其他速度比賽設計的封閉賽道

21. **race** = group of humans traditionally classified by shared ancestry/physical traits (族群分類) — 種族；人種

A completely different noun meaning.

Meaning: A broad social/historical classification of people based on perceived ancestry and physical characteristics.

Practice 42

> “The form asks for information about **race** and ethnicity.”

「表格要求填寫有關**種族及族裔**的資料。」

Practice 43

> “The study examined differences in reported experiences across racial groups.”

「這項研究分析不同**種族群體**所報告經歷的差異。」

race = 社會 / 歷史上按祖源及被認為共有的外貌特徵等因素形成的人群分類概念

Important note:

race is a social category whose definitions vary across societies and institutions; it should not be treated as a simple biological classification.

22. **racial (種族相關的) — 種族的 ; 與種族有關的**

A common related adjective.

Practice 44

> “The organization provides training on **racial equality**.”

「該機構提供有關**種族平等**的培訓。」

Practice 45

> “The report discusses **racial discrimination**.”

「報告討論**種族歧視**問題。」

racial = 與種族分類、種族身份或不同種族群體之間的關係有關的

23. **racism (種族歧視 / 種族主義) — 種族主義 ; 種族歧視**

A related but separate lexical item.

Practice 46

> “The campaign aims to challenge **racism**.”

「這項運動旨在反對**種族主義 / 種族歧視**。」

Practice 47

> “The company has policies against **racism**.”

「公司有反對**種族歧視**的政策。」

racism = 基於種族分類而產生的偏見、歧視，或主張某些種族優越 / 低劣的思想

This should be labelled as a **family extension**, not another sense of bare **race**.

24. **human race (全人類) — 人類 ; 全人類**

A fixed expression.

Practice 48

> “Climate change affects the entire **human race**.”

「氣候變化影響**全人類**。」

Practice 49

> “The discovery could benefit the **human race**.”

「這項發現可能令**整個人類**受益。」

the human race = 全體人類作為一個物種 / 整體

This differs from the social-category sense of **race**.

25. **race** = breed/lineage of animals (品種 / 血統 ; 較舊 / 專門) — 品系 ; 種類

An older/specialized sense.

Practice 50

> “The text refers to an ancient **race of horses**.”

「文章提到一種古老的馬匹**品系**。」

Practice 51

> “The species developed into several distinct local **rac**es.”

「這個物種發展出幾個不同的地方**類群 / 品系**。」

This usage exists in biology/history but is less central for ordinary learners and should be treated cautiously.

26. **race through** + work/book/task (飛快完成 / 閱讀) — 快速做完 ; 飛快讀完

A common figurative verb construction.

Practice 52

> “She **raced through** the final slides.”

「她**飛快地講完 / 略過**最後幾張投影片。」

Practice 53

> “I **raced through** the report before the meeting.”

「我在會議前**快速看完**了報告。」

race through something = 以非常快的速度完成、閱讀或處理某件事

This can imply excessive speed.

27. **race ahead** (迅速領先 / 快速發展) — 快速領先；迅速向前

Practice 54

> “The company **raced ahead** of its competitors.”

「公司迅速**領先競爭對手**。」

Practice 55

> “Technology is **racing ahead**.”

「科技正在**飛速發展**。」

race ahead = 非常快速地前進、發展或取得領先地位

28. **race from one thing/place to another** (匆忙奔波) — 匆匆趕來趕去

Practice 56

> “She spent the morning **racing from one meeting to another**.”

「她整個早上都在不同會議之間**匆忙趕來趕去**。」

Practice 57

> “I was **racing from task to task** all day.”

「我整天都在不同工作之間**忙著趕來趕去**。」

race from X to Y = 因時間緊迫而非常快速地在不同地方 / 工作之間移動

Important distinction: **race vs run**

run

means:

> move on foot faster than walking.

race

can mean:

1. compete for speed;
2. move extremely quickly.

Compare:

> “She **ran** to the station.”

= 她跑去車站。

> “She **raced** to the station.”

= 她**飛奔 / 急速趕去**車站。

Race adds urgency or competition.

Important distinction: **race vs compete**

race

focuses especially on:

- * speed;
- * being first;
- * reaching a goal before others.

compete

is much broader:

> compete in skill, price, quality, elections, sport, etc.

All races are competitions, but not all competitions are races.

Important distinction: **race = competition vs race = move quickly**

Competition:

> “They raced each other.”

= 他們互相比速度。

Fast movement:

> “She raced home.”

= 她飛快趕回家。

The second needs no competitor.

Important distinction: **heart races vs heart beats**

heart beats

neutral:

> the heart is functioning / beating.

heart races

means:

> the heartbeat is unusually fast.

So:

> “My heart was beating.”

does not automatically suggest anxiety.

> “My heart was racing.”

strongly suggests fast heartbeat caused by emotion/exertion.

Important distinction: **heart races vs heart pounds**

heart races

focuses on **speed**.

heart pounds

focuses on **force/intensity**.

A nervous person may say:

> “My heart was racing and pounding.”

= 心跳又快又強烈。

Important distinction: **mind races vs mind goes blank**

These are almost opposite reactions, and both relate nicely to your passage.

mind races

= many thoughts come very quickly.

mind goes blank

= thoughts suddenly disappear / you cannot think.

A nervous person can experience either, or even move rapidly between the two.

Important distinction: **race against time vs hurry**

hurry

= do/move something quickly because time is limited.

race against time

= urgently try to finish before a critical deadline.

The second is stronger and more dramatic.

Important distinction: **race for vs race against**

race against someone

= compete directly with that person.

> "She raced against me."

race for something

= compete to obtain a result/prize/position.

> "They are in the race for first place."

So:

against = opponent

for = goal/prize

Important distinction: **race vs ethnicity**

These are related in social classification but not identical.

race

typically refers to broad socially constructed categories associated historically with perceived ancestry and physical traits.

ethnicity

usually emphasizes:

* cultural background;

- * ancestry;
- * language;
- * traditions;
- * shared heritage.

A person's race and ethnicity may be recorded separately.

Important distinction: **race vs nationality**

race

= social grouping based on perceived ancestry/physical characteristics.

nationality

= legal/political membership of a nation or country.

For example, people of different racial or ethnic backgrounds may share the same nationality.

Important distinction: **race vs human race**

race — social category

> “race and ethnicity”

= 種族及族裔

human race

= all humanity

> “the future of the human race”

= 人類的未來

These should not be conflated.

Important distinction: **racing vs rushing**

racing

often suggests:

- * very high speed;
- * competitive or urgent motion.

rushing

focuses more on:

- * doing something hurriedly;
- * insufficient time;
- * lack of care.

> “I rushed through the presentation.”

often implies I went too quickly.

> “My heart was racing.”

cannot normally be replaced with:

> “My heart was rushing.”

Family-extension sweep

The practical **race** family is rich in speed, competition, urgency, and social classification:

- * **race — competition** = 競速比賽
- * **race — compete** = 參加速度競賽
- * **race against someone** = 跟某人比速度
- * **race to somewhere** = 飛快趕往某地
- * **race away/off/home** = 高速離開 / 趕回
- * **heart races** = 心跳加速
- * **mind/thoughts race** = 思緒飛快運轉
- * **pulse races** = 脈搏加快
- * **race against time** = 爭分奪秒
- * **race to do something** = 爭相做某事
- * **race for something** = 競逐某個目標 / 職位 / 獎項
- * **race — competitive struggle** = 激烈競爭
- * **arms race** = 軍備競賽
- * **space race** = 太空競賽
- * **race — election contest** = 選舉競逐
- * **racing** = 競速運動

* **racer** = 賽車手 / 競速選手
 * **racecourse** = 賽馬場 / 競賽場地
 * **racetrack** = 賽道
 * **race — social category** = 種族 / 人種社會分類
 * **racial** = 種族相關的
 * **racism** = 種族主義 / 種族歧視
 * **human race** = 全人類
 * **race through something** = 快速處理 / 讀完
 * **race ahead** = 快速領先 / 飛速發展
 * **race from one thing to another** = 匆忙奔波

The main semantic branches are:

> **competition based on speed**

> **move / happen extremely quickly**

> **urgent competition toward a goal**

> **social/historical human classification**

with several important figurative extensions.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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race — speed competition	參賽者比較速度，看誰最先到達終點的比賽
race — compete	在速度比賽中跟其他人競爭
race against someone	跟另一個人 / 隊伍直接比較速度
race to + place	以非常快的速度奔向 / 趕往某個地方
heart races	心臟因緊張、恐懼、興奮或運動而快速跳動
mind/thoughts race	很多想法在短時間內快速出現，使思緒停不下來
pulse races	脈搏快速跳動
race against time	因時間非常有限而必須爭分奪秒完成某件事
race to do something	多方快速行動，希望比別人更早完成或取得某事
race for something	多個人 / 團體競爭取得同一職位、獎項或結果
race — competitive struggle	多方為領先或首先達成目標而展開的競爭
arms race	多方不斷增加軍事能力 / 武器以免被對方超越的競賽
space race	不同國家 / 組織競爭取得太空科技 / 探索成果
race — election contest	多名候選人競爭取得同一選舉職位的競逐
racing	以速度競賽為核心的運動 / 活動
racer	參與競速比賽的人、動物或車輛
racecourse	特別為賽馬 / 競速活動而設的場地或路線

racetrack	為車輛、跑步或其他速度競賽設計的賽道	
race — social category	社會 / 歷史上按祖源及被認為共有的外貌特徵等因素形成的人群分類概念	
racial	與種族分類、身份或不同種族群體關係有關的	
human race	全體人類作為一個整體 / 物種	
race through something	以非常快的速度完成、閱讀或處理某件事	
race ahead	非常快速地前進、發展或取得領先	
race from X to Y	因時間緊迫而在不同地方 / 工作之間快速奔波	

For your original passage

> “My heart would ****race****, my mind would go blank, and I would start imagining the worst.”

The exact meaning is:

****race = 以非常快的速度跳動；這裡指因緊張而心跳突然加速****

Therefore:

> ****my heart would race****

= ****「我會心跳加速 / 我的心會跳得非常快」****

This is not a competition meaning.

The semantic path is:

> ****race = move very fast****

→

> ****heart races = heart beats very fast****

So the key mapping in your passage is:

****race = 快速跳動****

The most important learner contrasts are:

> ****run a race****

> = 參加賽跑

> ****race against someone****

> = 跟某人比速度

> ****race to the station****

> = 飛快趕去車站

> ****my heart is racing****

> = 我心跳很快

> ****my mind is racing****

> = 我腦中思緒飛快運轉

> ****race against time****

> = 爭分奪秒

> ****race for the title****

> = 爭奪冠軍

> ****technology race****

> = 科技競爭

> ****race and ethnicity****

> = 種族與族裔

> ****human race****

> = 全人類

So ****race**** is much richer than simply:

> ****race = 賽跑****

and in your passage specifically, it means:

*****“to beat extremely quickly because of nervousness.”*****